Mathieu Dubied

European University Institute, Badia Fiesolana, 50014 Florence, Italy
mathieu.dubied@eui.eu

Education

European University Institute — *Florence, Italy*
PhD in Political and Social Sciences — *2025 - present*
- Supervisors: Kevin Munger, Arnout van de Rijt

New York University — *New York, United States*
Master Thesis at NYU's Center for Social Media, AI, and Politics (CSMAP) — *02/2025 - 05/2025*
- Visit of 4 months for the Master's thesis: "What Drives Toxic Comments on TikTok? Examining the Link Between Videos and Comments Using Machine Learning".

University of Zurich — *Zurich, Switzerland*
Master of Arts in Social Sciences, Political Science — *2022 - 2025*
- Track: Democracy, Development and International Relations.

ETH Zurich — *Zurich Switzerland*
MSc Robotics, Systems and Control — *2021 - 2024*
- Focus on nonlinear system modeling and model predictive control.

Imperial College London — *London, United Kingdom*
Exchange year (SEMP), MEng Electrical and Electronic Engineering — *2021 - 2022*
- Focus on multi-agent systems, optimization and machine learning.

ETH Zurich — *Zurich, Switzerland*
BSc Mechanical Engineering — *2018 - 2021*
- Focus Specialization: Engineering for Health.

Professional Experience

09/2024-12/2025	**Research Assistant**, with Daniele Caramani, Department of Political Science, University of Zurich *Topic modeling, deep learning and LLM classifiers, data collection (web scraping) and visualisation.*
08/2024-02/2025	**Research Assistant**, with Johannes Köhler, Institute for Dynamic Systems and Control, ETH Zurich *Preparation for the publication of my master's thesis on learning-based model predictive control*
02/2023-02/2025	**Workshop Instructor**, GirlsCodeToo *Creation and teaching of a weekly programming course for girls between 9 and 12 years old*
09/2024-01/2025	**Teaching Assistant**, Department of Political Science, Universtity of Zurich *Preparation and teaching of weekly exercise sessions for the course "Political Systems and Theories"*
01/2024-08/2024	**Research Assistant**, with Isabelle Guinaudeau, Department of Political Science, University of Zurich *Development of a pipeline for the automated identification of social group mentions in newspapers*
10/2023-01/2024	**Research Assistant**, with Robert Katzschmann, Soft Robotics Lab, ETH Zurich *Independent research and preparation of a journal paper*
04/2023-09/2023	**Intern**, Short-term network modeling, Swissgrid *Development, testing, and deployment of an optimization application used in the grid control room*
09/2022-03/2023	**Head Teaching Assistant**, "Engineering Mechanics", ETH Zurich *Presentation of colloquia in front of over 200 students, preparation of lectures, exercises and exams*
2020-2021	**Teaching Assistant**, "Dynamics" and "Mechanics II", ETH Zurich *Teaching of weekly exercise sessions for 20-30 students in "Dynamics" and "Mechanics II"*

Publications

Peer-reviewed

M. Dubied, A. Lahr, M. Zeilinger, J. Köhler. December 2026. *A Robust and Adaptive MPC Formulation for Gaussian Process Models*. Automatica.

M. Scott, **M. Dubied**, J. Pitt. November 2022. *Social Motives and Social Contracts in Cooperative Survival Games*. International Workshop on Coordination, Organizations, Institutions, Norms and Ethics for Governance of Multi-Agent Systems (COINE).

M. Dubied, M. Y. Michelis, A. Spielberg, R. K. Katzschmann. April 2022. *Sim-to-Real for Soft Robots using Differentiable FEM: Recipes for Meshing, Damping, and Actuation*. IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L).

Under Review

S. Šarenkapa, I. Guinaudeau, E. Deiss-Helbig, **M. Dubied**, R. Heiberger, T. Matthieß. *Detecting Social Groups in French and German Newspaper Corpora*. R&R Political Analysis.

M. Dubied, P. Tiso, R. K. Katzschmann. November 2025. *AquaROM: Shape Optimization Pipeline for Soft Swimmers Using Nonlinear Parametric Reduced Order Models*. R&R IEEE Transactions on Robotics.

Work in Progress

M. Dubied, B. Guinaudeau, K. Donnay, J. A. Tucker. *What Drives Toxic Comments on TikTok? Examining the Link Between Videos and Comments Using Machine Learning*.

M. Dubied, H. Subtil. *The Global Laws Dataset*.

K. Munger, **M. Dubied**, M. Echevarria-Eirea, F. Pawelczyk, S. Ramirez-Ruiz. *IYKYK: Onlineness and the Visual Decoding of Political Ideology*.

Awards, Scholarships, and Grants

Academic

2025 **Merit Scholarship for Research Stay Abroad**, Vincent Merkle Foundation, 5'000CHF
2023 **Werner Siemens Fellowship**, Werner Siemens-Stiftung, 19'200CHF
2021 **SEMP Scholarship**, ETH Zurich, 3'800CHF
2021 **Merit Annual Scholarship**, Swiss Study Foundation, 20'000CHF
2020 **Nomination for the "Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award"**, D-MAVT, ETH Zurich
2019 **Member of the Swiss Study Foundation**, Swiss Study Foundation
2019 **Winner of the "Innovation Project"**, PDZ, ETH Zurich
2013 **Sciences Prize**, Cycle d'Orientation Sarine-Ouest

Non-academic

2025 **SATW Grants for Member Organisations**, Swiss Academy of Engineering Sciences SATW, project "Robotic Arm x GenAI" by GirlsCodeToo, 5'000CHF
2025 **Financial aid for projects on gender equality in the workplace**, Swiss Federal Office for Gender Equality FOGE, project "Printed by Code: Girls & Women Shaping Ideas" by GirlsCodeToo, 200'000CHF
2024 **Selected Pitch**, ETH Sustainable Development Goals Pitch Event
2024 **Nomination for the ETH "Diversity Award"**, nominated for the work at GirlsCodeToo
2005-2019 **Various prizes in swimming competitions**

Volunteering and Services

Volunteering

2026-present **Team captain**, EUI rowing team
2024-present **Board Member and Treasurer**, GirlsCodeToo
2023-present **Active Member**, GirlsCodeToo
2022-present **Secondary School Delegate**, Swiss Study Foundation
2023-2025 **Council Member**, University of Zurich Student Association (VSUZH)
2024 **Reading Group Organizer**, Swiss Study Foundation
2015-2019 **Webmaster**, Fribourg Natation 1925
2016-2017 **High school student committee**, Collège Sainte-Croix, Fribourg
2015-2017 **Team Captain**, Fribourg Aquatics

Review services

2026 **Reviewer**, Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media, IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L), IEEE Transactions on Robotics (T-RO, IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS))
2025 **Reviewer**, IEEE Transactions on Robotics (T-RO)
2024 **Reviewer**, IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA)

Conferences, Workshops, and Summer Schools

09/2026	**APSA Annual Meeting**, Presentation of the paper “What drives toxic comments on TikTok? A large-scale descriptive study”
02/2026	**GESIS Panel.dbd Insight Days**, Workshop on Panel.dbd web-tracking data by GESIS Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences
11/2025	**Digital Democracy Workshop 2025**, Single track conference organized by the Digital Society Initiative at the University of Zurich
07/2025	**Tableau de la Suisse: Switzerland’s Model of Success**, Summer school of the Swiss Study Foundation (1 week)
09/2023	**Urban Forests – for Sustainable, Liveable and Healthy Cities**, Summer school of the Swiss Study Foundation (1 week)
08/2023	**Music, Computation and the Mind**, Summer school of the Swiss Study Foundation (1 week)
03/2022	**The Politics of Youth Representation at the United Nations**, Spring school of the German Study Foundation (1 week)
09/2021	**Fundamental Questions of State Theory and State Philosophy in the Early 21st Century**, Summer school of the Swiss Study Foundation (1 week)

Skills

Languages	French (native), English (C1), German (C1), Swiss German (B2), Italian (A2)
Softwares	Python, Matlab, R, C++, Git, GitHub, Go, PSSE, Gurobi, PyTorch, CasADI, Comsol, NX, LaTeX, TikZ

Interests and Hobbies

Technical and scientific topics, politics, history and environment.

Mountaineering (member of the Swiss Alpine Club), climbing, rowing, hiking, reading, tinkering, sewing cool clothes.